

Runway at sea

Aircraft carriers are huge ships with flat decks which war planes use for taking off and landing. The carriers sail close to enemy coasts so the planes can launch attacks.

One of the crew uses a machine gun to defend the tank against enemy aircraft.



The wheels run inside tough metal bands called caterpillar tracks. To steer, the driver makes one track run faster than the other.

A nuclear explosion

1. As the bomb explodes, it makes a giant fireball.



2. The explosion shakes the city below.



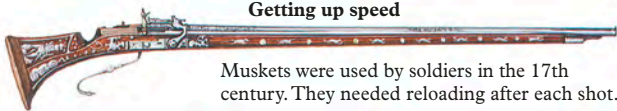
3. The blast and fire destroy buildings.



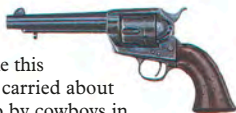
4. A cloud of rubble and dust mushrooms up high into the sky.



Getting up speed



Muskets were used by soldiers in the 17th century. They needed reloading after each shot.



Handguns like this Colt 45 were carried about 150 years ago by cowboys in the American west. They could fire six bullets without being reloaded.



Machine guns were invented in 1884 by Sir Hiram Maxim. They could fire dozens of bullets one after the other.



Destruction caused by a nuclear bomb in Hiroshima, Japan, 1945.

Nuclear weapons

A single nuclear bomb can destroy a whole city, and the radiation it leaves behind can kill people and animals years later. There are now enough nuclear weapons to destroy the world.

